

Professional Portfolio Website

9/15/2026

10 Points Possible

Attempt 1



In Progress

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Purpose

For this assignment, you will create (or update) a professional portfolio website to advertise yourself to potential employers (or grad schools). A well developed website goes way beyond what you can do on a site like LinkedIn, as [one junior developer explains \(https://sarakhandaker.medium.com/do-i-really-need-a-portfolio-website-ebab7030c4ba\)](https://sarakhandaker.medium.com/do-i-really-need-a-portfolio-website-ebab7030c4ba). Even if you do not end up using a website as part of your job search, this assignment serves as good practice in articulating your accomplishments succinctly (which will come in handy in interviews), and in persuasive writing generally.

Some notes before getting started

A note on privacy: I highly value your privacy. To that end, I do not want you to publish any identifying personal information about yourself *for the purposes of this assignment*. Do not include your last name, phone number, email address, residential address, photograph, or any other identifying information, unless you want to do so. The only reason to include any of that, such as your last name or a photograph, is if you want the website you create for this assignment to double as your actual personal website that you use in your job search. However, it may be a good idea to simply create a separate version just for this assignment, so that you can make sure to meet the assignment requirements without having to worry about messing up your actual website.

A note on NDAs & course content: Obviously, if you signed an NDA for an internship or job saying you wouldn't share information about what you did for them, then you can't put that in your portfolio. Maybe there's a way to talk about what you did in more general terms (read your NDA and see how flexible it is!), but I really don't want you to get in trouble for this assignment, so use your judgement. You should also be careful not to share specific information about how you approached recurring course projects (e.g., 280 euchre, 485 Instagram clone) that could be used by current or future students to gain an unfair advantage on the assignments. If you're unsure, come talk to me!

A note on expense: I do not want you to spend money *for the purposes of this assignment* by, for instance, purchasing a domain or paying for premium templates. Again, you're welcome to do that if

you want to use this website in your job search, but you will not be graded on whether or not you spent money. For instance, you will not be marked down if there are ads or branding for a free website tool you used.

A note on web development: Some of you certainly have web development experience. Some of you may want to work on those skills. If so, that's great! I encourage you to practice those skills and try to craft a unique and professional-looking website. However, that is not what I will be grading for the purposes of this assignment. If you have never worked on a website before, you can put together a simple, static site that, for the purposes of this assignment, is just as good as one that another student spent hours coding and created custom javascript elements for. You may use AI to put together a website that's at least functional, with little to no web development experience.

A note on hosting: I recommend using Github Pages. It's what most students use, and there's lots of documentation and troubleshooting tips online. If you've used Github before, then it should be very simple to set it up, and if you've never used Github before, it may be a bit confusing at first, but I'd recommend trying it out just to get some experience with it. All that said, you're welcome to use whatever hosting platform you want. You could use a free website builder/host, like Wordpress, Wix, Canva, etc., or you could go for something more customizable like a VPS.

A note on AI: I am not requiring you to use your Google Drive folder to draft any content for this assignment, and you may use AI as much or as little as you want to for this assignment, including to draft written material, such as your About Me. It's probably still a good idea to edit your website so that it doesn't *look* AI-generated, and edit the written content so that it doesn't *sound* AI-generated.

Samples: The following samples are websites that I copied from former students, anonymized, and hosted on my own github. These aren't necessarily perfect, but they're meant to show you how students have approached this assignment in the past. These are also on the simpler side, but feel free to do something more complicated.

- [Example website 1 \(https://jmntg-umich.github.io/tc497_portfolio_1/index.html\)](https://jmntg-umich.github.io/tc497_portfolio_1/index.html)
- [Example website 2 \(https://jmntg-umich.github.io/tc497_portfolio_2/index.html\)](https://jmntg-umich.github.io/tc497_portfolio_2/index.html)
- [Example website 3 \(https://jmntg-umich.github.io/w26_ex1/\)](https://jmntg-umich.github.io/w26_ex1/)
- [Example website 4 \(https://jmntg-umich.github.io/w26_ex2/\)](https://jmntg-umich.github.io/w26_ex2/)

Ok, now to the assignment!

Prep work (due before class)

If you already have a personal website, you're welcome to use it, but go through the steps below and be sure that it meets the requirements for the assignment. You should create a copy for use in this class so you don't mess with the one you're actually using in your job search.

- Create a website and pick a domain name. If you feel confident developing a website from scratch, go for it! If not, no worries--there are a number of free drag-and-drop websites (just make sure you can publish it for free before working on it). Your domain name should be professional, but it's fine if it's a subdomain (e.g., studentname.weebly.com). Don't put your last name in your domain name if you don't want your last name to be public!
- Start crafting your website. Here are the components I'm looking for:
 - **An about me page.** This can be the home/landing page, or a separate page. See note on privacy above. If you don't want to include a picture of yourself (as in, you're just creating this website for this assignment), you can use an AI-generated avatar version of yourself or something like that. This page should be mainly about professional interests, but feel free to include some personal interests, hobbies, etc.
 - **Your CV/resume.** Do not just upload or embed a PDF of your resume. You should create this natively within the website, so that it matches the aesthetics and formatting of the rest of the site. You should also remove any identifying details like phone number (again, except for any personal info you want to include). You are also not limited by the dimensions of a page, so you can add information that you had to cut from your regular resume. **Include links** where possible, either to projects in your portfolio or to external websites (e.g., if you published an app, link to that app).
 - A well curated and organized **portfolio of your work**, including at least **three projects**. Ideally, I'd like you to include photos/screenshots of your work. Do not include any pictures of yourself (unless you want to) or anyone else (unless you have permission from them). This can be project work from a class, individual projects, or work you've done for a company (see note on NDAs & course content, above). The main point of the portfolio is to showcase the range of skills that you've developed over the last few years. If you're not sure how to include a project, talk to me!
 - Ensure that your site has a consistent and understandable **hierarchy**. The menu should be easy to find and use, and pages should be nested appropriately (e.g., you might create a page for each project, so those should be nested under a "Projects" page. All pages should be directly navigable from all other pages (as in, I should be able to get to any page with one click from any other page), and there should be logical connections between pages (e.g., if there's a project in your portfolio and you include it in your resume, there should be a link in your resume to the project in your portfolio).
 - Follow **web conventions**: use sans serif fonts for paragraph text, and justify your text (align it on both left and right) in relatively narrow columns (~10 words per line).
 - Use a consistent **color scheme** throughout the website.
 - Reduce excessive **line spacing**. This is often a problem with free website builders and templates--they come with very wide line spacing, that . Aim for spacing equivalent to 1.15-1.5 spacing in Google Docs or Word. Format your website for usability, and give it a consistent aesthetic.
 - Use **headers** (rather than just making paragraph text bigger/bolder) where needed (e.g., in your resume).

- Include **images** to support the argument you're making about yourself with this website. F. If you want to have decorative images, they should be related to your work (not just pretty).
- Create a PDF with the following content and submit it to this assignment:
 - A brief reflection that discusses:
 - A specific job or the type of job you are using (or would hypothetically use) this website to apply for (this can be the same one you've used for previous assignments)
 - The skills or qualifications you are trying to demonstrate with this website
 - Specific elements of the website that you feel demonstrate those skills or qualifications
 - A link to your live website. Make sure it's publicly accessible!
 - All of the pages of your site in PDF form. You can use the print to PDF function in your browser and then combine the pages using Adobe Acrobat or other software. This is not the main way anyone will be looking at your website, so don't worry if the formatting gets messed up. It's just to create a snapshot in time that you can look back later while you revise, and to provide a place for me to leave comments easily if needed.

In-class Workshop

- [Put a link to your website here](https://docs.google.com/document/d/1tOSqOTTr3clWoWRgd67JzGDcDOlyOO4AylejHmNFRgM/edit?usp=sharing)
(<https://docs.google.com/document/d/1tOSqOTTr3clWoWRgd67JzGDcDOlyOO4AylejHmNFRgM/edit?usp=sharing>)
- [Further instructions here](https://docs.google.com/presentation/d/1_szd3Fs6MOoU7WyOZvPO7Su1fjsB8MplHd6Xs0Jd37k/edit?usp=sharing)
(https://docs.google.com/presentation/d/1_szd3Fs6MOoU7WyOZvPO7Su1fjsB8MplHd6Xs0Jd37k/edit?usp=sharing)
- Notes on [WAVE](https://wave.webaim.org/): (<https://wave.webaim.org/>)
 - Start by unchecking "features," "structural elements," and "ARIA." You can turn them back on later, but these tend to clutter the screen and make it hard to see the errors.
 - Click around on the different issues. If you click on the issue on the webpage, you'll see a brief description of the issue, along with "reference" and "code." Read the reference (on the left side of the screen) and the actual html where there's an issue (on the bottom of the screen).
 - Not all errors flagged by WAVE are actually problems. If you find an error that you don't think was appropriately flagged, discuss it.

Asynchronous option

If you have to miss class, you can earn credit by **a)** communicating with me about your absence and indicating that you would like to do this asynchronous option, and **b)** participating in an online workshop (conditional on a sufficient number of other students also participating).

Instructions

- **By 3pm Weds:** Submit the prep work here and let me know you'd like to do the asynchronous option
- **By midnight Thurs:** Make copies of [this worksheet](https://docs.google.com/document/d/15kbP0Ef9JELOLPh1P1N81lssLrmucrif0agtbNHhoU/edit?usp=sharing) (<https://docs.google.com/document/d/15kbP0Ef9JELOLPh1P1N81lssLrmucrif0agtbNHhoU/edit?usp=sharing>) in your shared Drive folder and complete one for each assigned website. Upload your completed worksheet as an assignment comment for each peer.
- **By midnight Fri:** In a Google Doc in your shared Drive folder, write a reflection based on the feedback you received and the other websites you looked at:
 - What are the most effective/important ways you could improve your website?
 - When first designing the site, did you have any competing priorities that required you to strike a balance (e.g., aesthetics vs. accessibility, concision vs. completeness)? How did you choose to find a balance, and why? After receiving feedback, would you choose a different balance?
 - How relevant/useful do you think a portfolio website is? Connect it to your specific career goals.
- You do not need to submit the reflection here.

✓ View Rubric

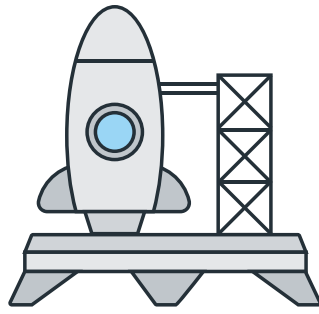
Professional Website Rubric		
Criteria	Comments	Points
Content view longer description	Comment	/4 pts
Navigation/usability view longer description	Comment	/4 pts
Aesthetics/professionalism view longer description	Comment	/2 pts

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